

TCG Sealed Product — Wholesale Sourcing Guide

Prepared for PathBinder LLC · July 2026 · Distributor contacts, requirements & next steps

Bottom line. Opening authorized distributor accounts is the easy part (LLC + EIN + a state resale certificate). The hard parts: (1) **manufacturer-direct is closed** to an online-only seller — distributors are the only channel; (2) as a new online account you get **little-to-no allocation of the hot sets** until you build order history; and (3) **sealed margins are thin (~10–25% net)**, not the 60–80% quoted online (that figure is for cracking packs into singles). Start with distributors that welcome online sellers, build history on general product, and get the "our own marketplace" question cleared in writing before scaling restricted sealed.

1. What You Need Before Applying

Requirement	Details	Status
Business entity	LLC formed (PathBinder LLC).	DONE
EIN	Federal employer ID number.	DONE
State resale / sales-tax certificate	The critical one — every distributor requires it (makes wholesale purchases tax-exempt). ~13 states reject out-of-state certs, and GTS ships from WA, Alliance from MD (both on that list). Get your home-state cert first; ask a sales-tax pro whether you also need WA/MD. Backups: MTC and Streamlined (SST) multistate forms.	NEEDED
Business license	From your home jurisdiction.	NEEDED
Business bank account + credit card	New accounts start on prepay / credit card ; net-30 terms are earned later via order history, not granted at signup.	NEEDED
Live website (own domain) + business email	Distributors want to see a real operation. PokeUnlimited specifically requires website / social-media links.	NEEDED
Photo ID	Alliance's new-account packet requires one.	HAVE
Working capital	Plan ~\$750+ order sizes (GTS free-ship threshold), PokeUnlimited's \$1,000/mo minimum , and possible \$250–500 first-order minimums elsewhere.	PLAN

2. Distributor Contact List

Ranked by ease of entry for a new, online-only seller. Contact each to confirm current terms — online-only acceptance is firmly documented only for PokeUnlimited (yes) and Southern Hobby (no).

Tier A — Apply this week (they accept online sellers)

Distributor	Carries	Contact & How to Apply	Key Terms / Notes
PokeUnlimited Tampa, FL	Pokémon, One Piece, Lorcana (also Riftbound, Dragon Ball, Gundam). No Magic / Yu-Gi-Oh.	Web: pokeunlimited.com/pages/wholesale Email: support@pokeunlimited.com Needs: resale cert + proof of business + website/social links.	Explicitly welcomes online sellers (easiest yes). \$1,000/mo minimum. Sub-distributor — thinner margins; confirm sealed sourcing.

Distributor	Carries	Contact & How to Apply	Key Terms / Notes
GTS Distribution Sumner, WA	Pokémon, Magic, Yu-Gi-Oh, Dragon Ball, Vanguard. OP / Lorcanan likely — verify.	Web: gtsdistribution.com (open account) Phone: 800-890-5456 Email: customercare@gtsdistribution.com 2-step: pre-screen survey → New Account app; submit resale cert + sales-tax docs.	Broadest coverage; opens general accounts to online retailers. Read Terms — "Brick-and-Mortar Exclusive" SKUs (hottest releases) are off-limits to online sellers. Ships from WA.
ACD Distribution Middleton, WI	Pokémon, Magic, Yu-Gi-Oh confirmed; OP / Lorcanan via Bandai/Ravensburger lines — verify SKUs.	Web: acdd.com/account-application Email: applications@acdd.com Fax: 1-608-203-9905 · Phone: 1-800-767-4263 Needs: EIN, resale cert, business docs.	27,000+ SKUs; reliable fill on standard product. Confirm online-only acceptance directly.

Tier B — Apply with eyes open (real friction)

Distributor	Carries	Contact & How to Apply	Key Terms / Notes
Alliance (Diamond) Hunt Valley, MD	All five games + board games, RPGs, miniatures.	Web: alliance-games.com Needs: resale cert, business license, photo ID.	Caution: not accepting new accounts whose primary interest is allocated CCG product (hot sealed) — may be declined/restricted. Good for the general catalog. Ships from MD.
Magazine Exchange Grants Pass, OR	Pokémon, Magic, Yu-Gi-Oh + sports. OP / Lorcanan NOT confirmed.	Web: magazine-exchange.com Register a business / wholesale account (reseller license).	One of 3 Upper Deck Authorized Hobby Distributors. Online-only acceptance not stated — ask.

Tier C — Skip for now (blocked for online-only)

Distributor	Carries	Contact & How to Apply	Key Terms / Notes
Southern Hobby Nashville, TN	All five games (confirmed catalog).	Web: southernhobby.com/new_account.php Phone: (800) 473-2804	Online-only applications NOT considered — brick-and-mortar storefront required. Revisit only if you open a storefront.
PHD Games Longwood, FL	All five games.	Web: phdgames.com/open-an-account	Paused new online-only gaming accounts (as of July 2026). Recheck in ~60–90 days.

3. Your Catalog Coverage — All 7 Games

PathBinder carries seven live games. **Six are covered by the distributor accounts above** — only Azuki needs a different channel. Key point: One Piece, Dragon Ball, and Gundam are all **Bandai** products, so a single Bandai-carrying distributor (GTS, Alliance, or Southern Hobby) covers all three at once.

Game	Where to source	Notes
Pokémon	Any Tier A/B distributor	Hot sets are allocation-limited for new accounts.

Game	Where to source	Notes
Magic	GTS, ACD, Alliance, Magazine Exchange	WPN-restricted new releases are off-limits to online sellers.
Yu-Gi-Oh	GTS, ACD, Alliance, Magazine Exchange	Product within ~90 days of release may be restricted.
One Piece	PokeUnlimited, ACD, Alliance, GTS (verify)	Bandai.
Gundam	PokeUnlimited + any Bandai distributor (GTS / Alliance / Southern Hobby)	Bandai; newer line (2025).
Lorcana	PokeUnlimited, ACD, Alliance	Ravensburger; pre-wide-release is restricted.
Dragon Ball	PokeUnlimited, GTS + any Bandai distributor	Order " Super Card Game: Fusion World " (current Bandai product). Legacy Panini <i>Dragon Ball Z</i> is out of print — secondary-market only.
Azuki	DIRECT from Azuki only	First-party / web3 product — NOT in hobby distribution. Source via a direct partnership (the outreach already drafted).

Shortcut: one Bandai account = One Piece + Dragon Ball + Gundam (and Digimon if you add it later). Azuki is the only game that needs a separate, direct source.

4. Manufacturer-Direct — Not an Option (Yet)

For all five games, a new online-only retailer **cannot** buy manufacturer-direct. The programs people confuse with this — **WPN** (Magic), **Konami OTS** (Yu-Gi-Oh), **Bandai** store programs, and the **Lorcana Hobby Store Program** — are physical-storefront-gated *play/marketing* programs, not purchasing channels; even members buy their product through distributors. **Distributors are your only channel.** A physical location is the one thing that would later unlock manufacturer-adjacent early allocation.

Watch: Pokémon's parent (TPCI) announced (Feb 2026) an agreement to acquire Excell Brands, one of its largest US distributors — pending regulatory close. It could reshape Pokémon distributor access and terms.

5. The Honest Catches

- **Allocation is the #1 problem.** Hot Pokémon goes to established, high-volume accounts. Place consistent orders on general product first to become an "active account" before a big set drops — there's no shortcut.
- **Margins are thin:** plan for ~10–25% net on sealed boxes, not 60–80% (that's for cracking packs into singles).
- **2026 timing is adverse:** Pokémon is deliberately oversupplying; modern sealed is flat-to-below MSRP and no longer a safe "buy-and-hold."
- **MAP** caps the *advertised* price, not the sale price — you can sell above MAP on hot product, but can't publicly display below-MAP.
- **Grey-market sourcing** (when authorized is dry) costs more *and* carries counterfeit / resealed-box risk — if you unknowingly sell fakes, you carry the liability and your marketplace's reputation is on the line.
- **Highest priority — clear this in writing:** publishers ban "third-party marketplace" sales. Selling your own inventory on your own domain reads as fine, but because PathBinder *also* hosts third-party sellers, a publisher could characterize the whole platform as prohibited. No source settled this. Get written confirmation from each distributor/publisher before scaling restricted sealed, and keep first-party listings separate from third-party.

Ask every distributor these two questions — in writing — and keep the answers on file:

1. "Do you accept online-only sellers for a general wholesale account?"
2. "Do your reseller / MAP terms permit me to sell your sealed product on my own PathBinder-branded website?"

6. Recommended First Steps

- 1 Get your home-state resale / sales-tax certificate (and ask a sales-tax pro about WA + MD).
- 2 Confirm the basics are live: business bank account + credit card, and a working website on your own domain.
- 3 Apply to **PokeUnlimited** (welcomes online sellers) and **GTS** (broadest coverage — gets you Magic + Yu-Gi-Oh too).
- 4 File the **ACD** application as your reliable second multi-line account.
- 5 Apply to **Alliance + Magazine Exchange** for breadth — ask Alliance up front about its allocated-CCG restriction.
- 6 Skip **Southern Hobby + PHD** for now; set a reminder to recheck PHD in ~60–90 days.
- 7 Ask every distributor the two questions above, in writing, and keep the answers on file.
- 8 Start orders on general / back-catalog sealed to build the account history that later earns allocation and net terms.

*Prepared July 2026 for PathBinder LLC. **Not legal or tax advice** — engage a sales-tax professional (state registration / nexus) and an attorney (MAP and the marketplace-characterization question) before scaling. Manufacturer-direct closure, allocation scarcity, MAP mechanics, and grey-market liability are high-confidence. Specific margin percentages, order minimums, and PHD's online-account pause come from operator/vendor sources and are directional — reconfirm at application. Distributor online-only acceptance is firmly documented only for PokeUnlimited (yes) and Southern Hobby (no); confirm the others directly.*